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John Altstadt stands in a cornfield across the street from his neighborhood in Hoffman Estates on Wednesday. The land is part of the Plum Farms property, for which a developer had sought a zoning change before reversing course. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

Data center developer halts plan after outcry

Residents protested after investigating firm's zoning request in Hoffman Estates

By Brian J. Rogal
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Just days before the Hoffman Estates Village Board was set to vote on a controversial plan to rezone a patch of farmland for possible use as a data center, the developer withdrew his request.

The sudden reversal came after a flurry of opposition in the northwest suburb and several nearby towns.

Residents packed a Hoffman Estates village planning meeting in early June, giving hours of testimony against the project. They protested, filed public records requests and signed petitions to deny the rezoning. A new data center campus at the 186-acre Plum Farms, they feared, would use too much power and water, cause noise pollution and possibly raise utility costs.

When Karis Critical, the data center developer leading the project, withdrew its petition for rezoning on Wednesday, five days before



a Village Board vote that was set to take place tonight, some in the community breathed a sigh of relief.

"This is a win for the whole community," said John Altstadt, a South Barrington resident who lives next to Plum Farms and helped garner thousands of signatures on a petition. "It's a health issue, and maybe that's why they backed off.

This was the wrong thing at the wrong time."

Karis Critical said it got the message.

"After several weeks of conversations with the Village and residents, we've decided the right step is to withdraw the current

Developer Karis Critical wanted Hoffman Estates village officials to rezone the agricultural property at Route 59 and Higgins Road, which could have allowed the construction of a data center there.

See **DATA** on Page A2

Khamenei family appears at funeral

Other sons of slain supreme leader seen, but not heir, as threats to Trump ramp up

By Nasser Karimi
and Jon Gambrell
ASSOCIATED PRESS

TEHRAN, Iran — Iran's top officials and brothers of the new supreme leader emerged into public view Sunday to attend funeral prayers for Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. Their appearance projected unity, defiance and confidence in their safety as Iran pushes back on U.S. demands in negotiations to permanently end the war.

Crowds of hundreds of thousands chanted "Death to America" and "Death to Israel," as they called for revenge over the Feb. 28 attack that killed the 86-year-old supreme leader and other top officials, triggering the war. Some hard-liners called for the assassination of President Donald Trump.

Iran's new supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, has yet to make an appearance in the funeral ceremonies, which are unfolding over several days. He is believed to be in hiding after reportedly being wounded in the airstrike that killed his father.

At the height of the war, before an April ceasefire, Israel had targeted top leaders, in at least one case likely using their public appearance to fix their position. It has also threatened to kill the younger Khamenei.

The U.S. is meanwhile pressing ahead with negotiations with Iran aimed at fully reopening the Strait of Hormuz, rolling back its disputed nuclear program and reaching a permanent end to the war. Talks appear to be on hold until after the burial.

Ziba Naderi, a nurse attending the funeral Sunday, said Iran needed to heed Mojtaba Khamenei's commands. "I heard the call

See **IRAN** on Page A9



A woman weeps Sunday at a service for the slain Ali Khamenei and members of his family in Tehran. ALTAf QADRI/AP



Capuchin monkeys ride tethered to the backs of dogs at the Banana Derby race at the Lake County Fairgrounds in Grayslake on July 29, 2015. JOSÉ M. OSORIO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

State adds big cats, bears, primates to animals banned from traveling acts

By Christiana Freitag
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

When Marc Ayers attended the Sangamon County Fair in New Berlin last year, he was on a mission to stop one attraction from returning to the state: the Banana Derby.

Ayers, the Illinois state director for Humane World for Animals, said the welfare group has been tracking the show for years. When he went to see it firsthand, he watched in horror as two capuchin monkeys, Gilligan and Bert,

dressed in children's clothing, were tethered to the backs of dogs as they raced around the show ring, he recalled.

"Gosh, those primates, the facial expressions they were making," Ayers said. "That's not a natural thing to see, monkeys riding dogs. They were desperately grabbing the rail to try to get off, and they couldn't."

After leaving the fair that June day, Ayers said, he promised himself that would be the last time the show came to Illinois.

"These awesome creatures that you see in the wild have been reduced to a bear riding a tricycle because a family thinks it's funny or entertaining," Ayers said. "It's all there to exploit them so that the carnival can make money hand over fist off the exploitation of that species."

A traveling show based in South Carolina, the Banana Derby has appeared at county fairs across Illinois for nearly two decades,

See **ANIMALS** on Page A4

NATION & WORLD

NATO faces Trump challenge

NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte has tried to keep the United States anchored to the world's biggest military alliance. But the goalposts keep shifting. **B1**

ARTS & LIVING

Pride, tears at July 4 concert

The Grant Park Music Festival's Independence Day Salute offered great music and emotional release for those who braved the elements to attend. **B5**

SPORTS

Trump calls, penalty is lifted

President Trump called FIFA's president on behalf of U.S. star Polarin Balogun, whose suspension was then lifted, allowing him to play against Belgium today. **C1**

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 80 L: 63
TUE. H: 86 L: 67
WED. H: 89 L: 73
Complete details on Page A16

INDEX

Almanac A9
Arts & Living B5
Comics B8-9
Crossword B9
Editorials A6
Horoscope B8
Nation & World B1
Obituaries A9
Television B7

179th year No. 187
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